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The bush is sweet

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As in the bush, negative stereotypes of people from other ethnicities, are frequently expressed, such as that Hausa are dishonest and that Tuaregs are thieves and dangerous. It is generally an insult to say to another WoDaaBe that he or she looks or behaves like a member of another ethnic group. Young men, for example, who stand in culturally defined joking-relationships (either in the same age group or cross-cousins) often refer to one another as Hausa or Tuaregs, intended then as a friendly insult. Too much association with members of other ethnic groups in the city is furthermore generally criticized and mocked. If people of other ethnicities greet me while I am tagging along with WoDaaBe friends when they go places to do hair dressing, my friends firmly tell me not to reply, explaining "these are Hausa" or "Tuaregs" thus "not our people." WoDaaBe endogamous practices, the preferred form of marriage being with one's cross-cousins, show in themselves the strong emphasis on maintaining separation from those defined as ethnic others. WoDaaBe are of course not alone in holding stereotypical views of other ethnic groups. People from other ethnicities also express stereotypes about the WoDaaBe (Dupire 1971[1960]:48; Horowitz 1972:113). Interrelations with the Beriberi in Niamey are characterized by a joking-relationship, which is similar to that between WoDaaBe cross-cousins (Dupire 1962a:27).⁶¹ WoDaaBe stereotypes of Hausa and Tuaregs do, however, not always correspond with actual relations between individuals of different ethnicities. At a name giving ceremony the mother invited several Hausa women who were "her friends." They were given honoree positions at the festival, and treated in all ways as honorable guests. My male friends also introduced me many times to Hausa and Tuaregs who had been their friends for a long time.

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⁶¹ Dupire mentions that the origin myth of the WoDaaBe lineage group Bi-utejo includes a narrative of the Beriberi. The Beriberi are said to have lived with the WoDaaBe, luring cows from water with fire and entrusting them to WoDaaBe, thus making the Beriberi and Boror

as close as cross-cousins (Dupire 1962a:29).

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